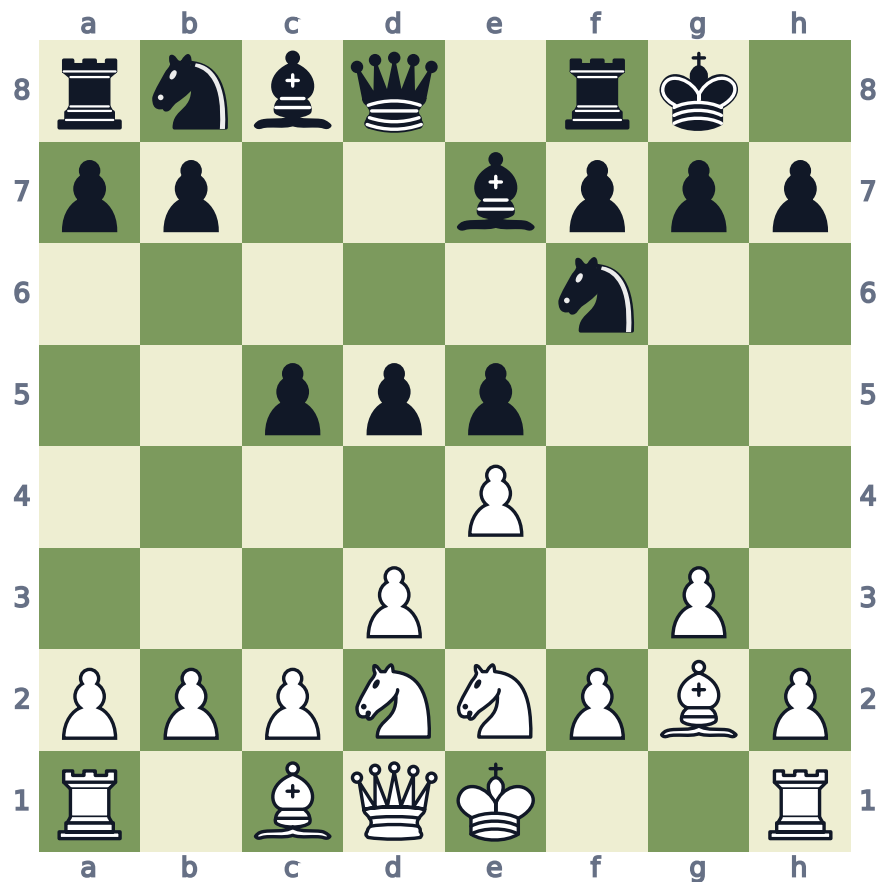


The White Hippo e4 and d4 Breaks

Preparation, contact, exchanges, closed centers, and piece activation



Calculate and execute the White Hippo's two main central breaks, including the structures created by every major reply.

8 learning units | solid-piece diagrams | recall tests | engine checks

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Calculate and execute the White Hippo's two main central breaks, including the structures created by every major reply.

THE WHITE HIPPO TRAINING LOOP

- Identify Black's center, both kings, and Black's most forcing pawn break.
- At every diagram compare e4, d4, c4, and f4 before choosing another setup move.
- Hide the answer until you have spoken the move, purpose, and Black's best reply.
- Replay each branch from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 8 units inside a connected 1.g3 repertoire. It teaches setup, exceptions, transformation, and resulting plans; the companion PGNs make later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

e4 usually attacks d5 and opens the g2 bishop's influence.

PRINCIPLE 2

d4 challenges e5 and can create an open or symmetrical center.

PRINCIPLE 3

A break is ready when pieces support the resulting files and squares.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

If Black closes, White needs a second break rather than more waiting moves.

PRINCIPLE 5

If Black exchanges, recapture choice determines piece activity.

PRINCIPLE 6

The correct break improves the worst piece and restricts Black's best counterbreak.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

- | | | |
|-----------|------------------------------------|---|
| 01 | Prepare e4 with d3 and Nd2 | The e4 break is ready when the pieces can use the opened lines. |
|
 | | |
| 02 | e4 against a French shell | e4 attacks the base only if a second break is available after d4. |
|
 | | |
| 03 | e4 against a Caro shell | Prepare the recapture and development before e4. |
|
 | | |
| 04 | e4 in a Sicilian structure | e4 is a structure choice, not merely a space move. |
|
 | | |
| 05 | Prepare d4 against e5 | d4 is ready when castling and piece activity survive the exchanges. |
|
 | | |
| 06 | d4 in a mirrored fianchetto | The extra tempo is converted into the first useful center break. |
|
 | | |
| 07 | d4 against a single e5 pawn | When d5 is unavailable, d4 gains more force. |
|
 | | |
| 08 | Choose between e4 and d4 | Compare which break opens your better bishop. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

Prepare e4 with d3 and Nd2



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c5 7. e4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Use d3, Nd2, and Ne2 to support e4 without blocking the f-pawn.

MAIN DANGER

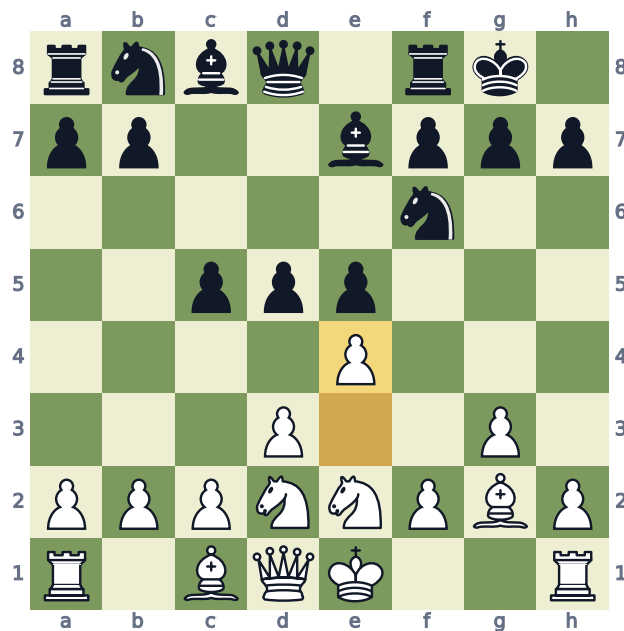
d4 can close the center and restrict the knights.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

The e4 break is ready when the pieces can use the opened lines.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -0.84 for White (Black is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nc6 O-O 2. Be6 b3 3. Qd7 Bb2

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

Prepare e4 with d3 and Nd2



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

e4 against a French shell



COURSE LINE

1. g3 e6 2. Bg2 d5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c5 7. e4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Challenge d5 and enter a King's Indian Attack structure.

MAIN DANGER

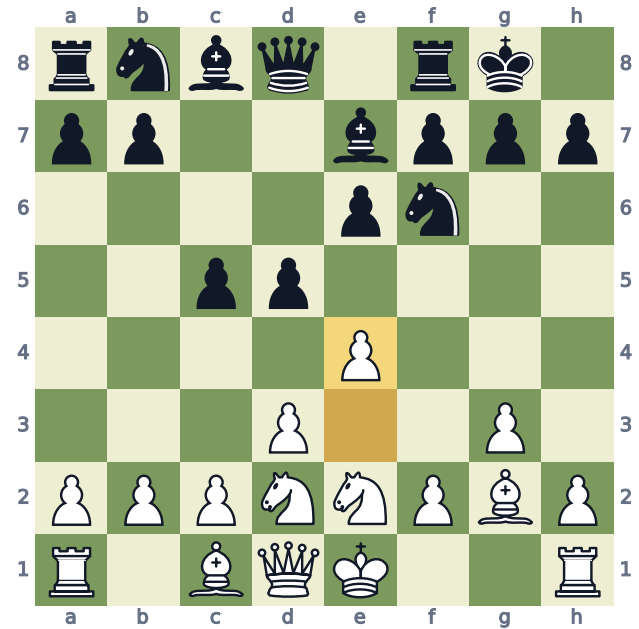
d4 can gain space and make c4 necessary later.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

e4 attacks the base only if a second break is available after d4.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -0.52 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nc6 exd5 2. exd5 O-O 3. Re8 Nf4 4. Bf8 Nf3 5. h6 h3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

e4 against a French shell



YOUR TASK

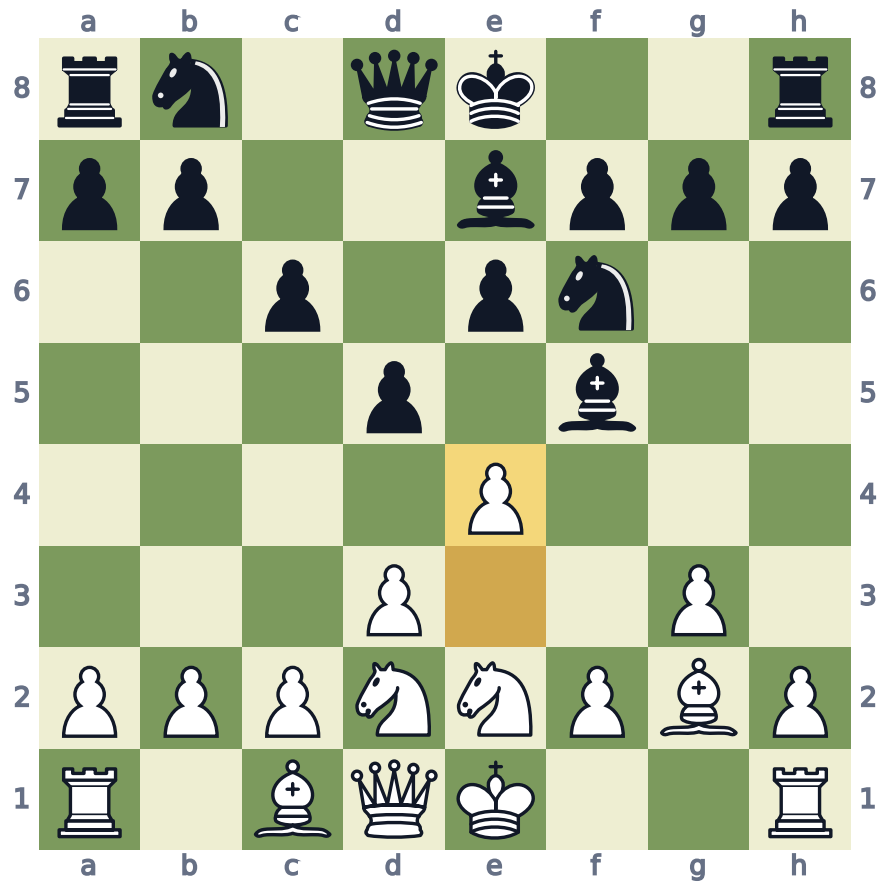
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

e4 against a Caro shell



COURSE LINE

1. g3 c6 2. Bg2 d5 3. d3 Bf5 4. Nd2 e6 5. e3 Nf6 6. Ne2 Be7 7. e4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

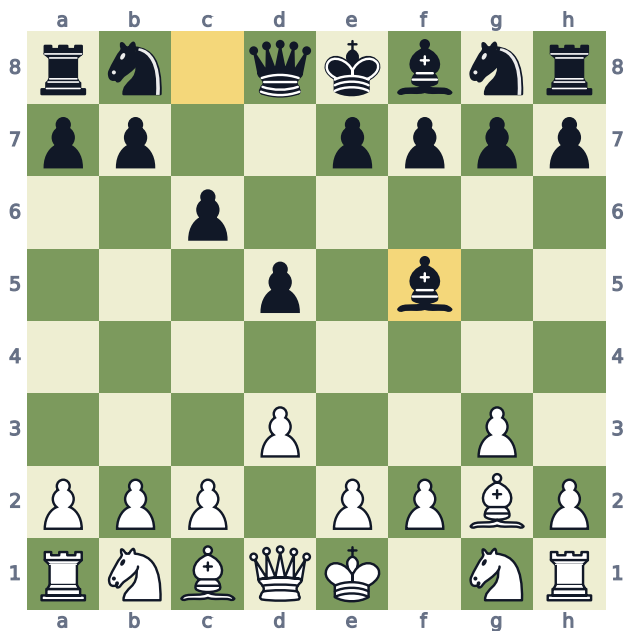
Open central contact after Black's bishop leaves c8.

MAIN DANGER

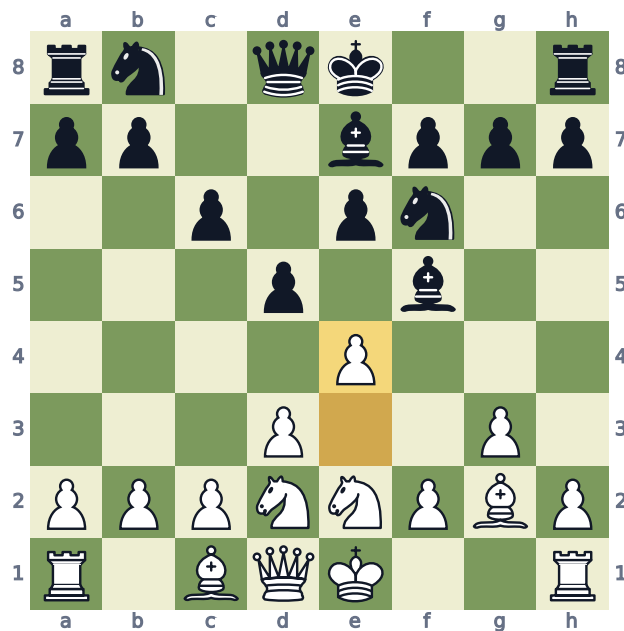
dx e4 can expose an uncastled king.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Prepare the recapture and development before e4.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.63 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bg6 Nf4 2. e5 Nxg6 3. hxg6 Qe2

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

e4 against a Caro shell



YOUR TASK

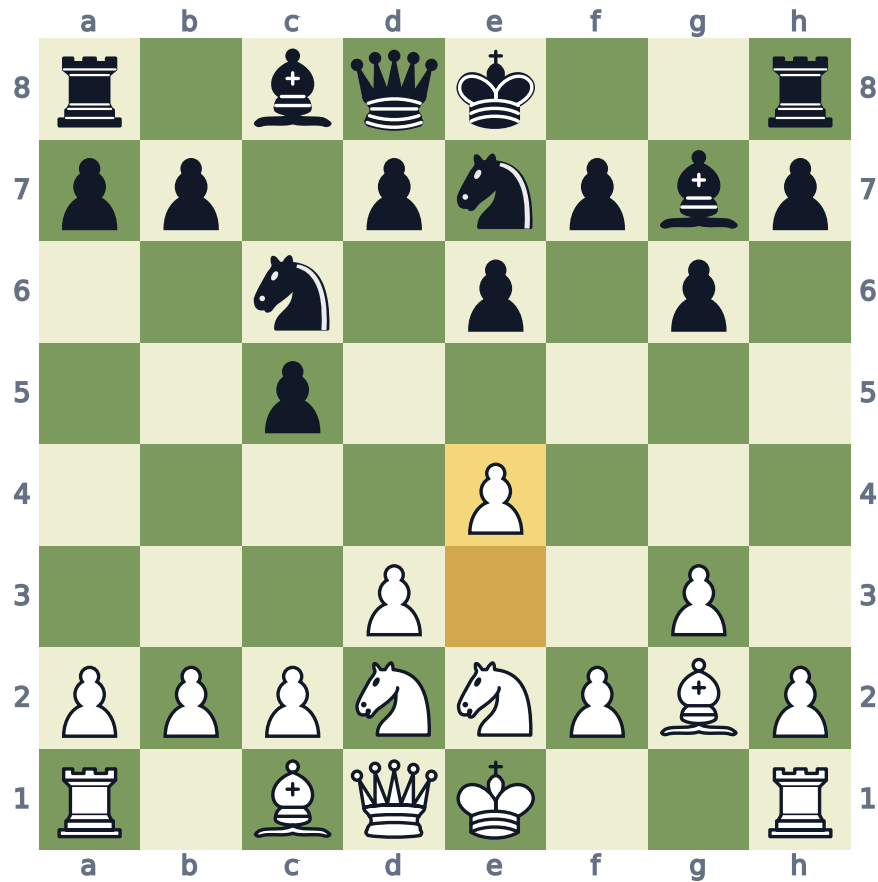
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

e4 in a Sicilian structure



COURSE LINE

1. g3 c5 2. Bg2 Nc6 3. d3 g6 4. Nd2 Bg7 5. e3 e6 6. Ne2 Nge7 7. e4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

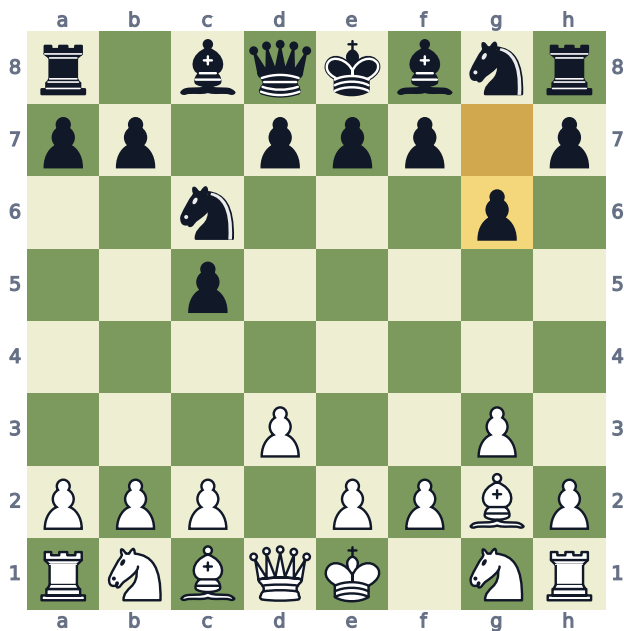
Build a Closed Sicilian center while preserving f4.

MAIN DANGER

d5 can strike the center immediately.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

e4 is a structure choice, not merely a space move.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

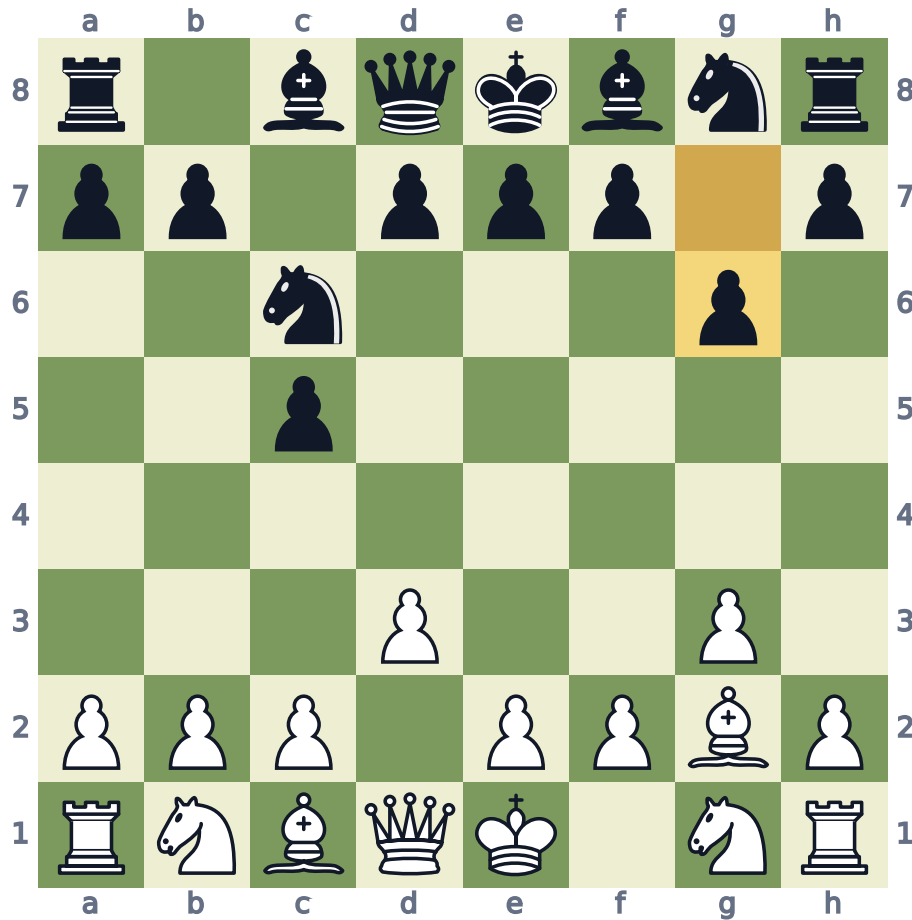
Position estimate: -0.55 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. O-O O-O 2. b6 Nf4 3. d5 exd5 4. Nxd5 Nxd5 5. exd5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

e4 in a Sicilian structure



YOUR TASK

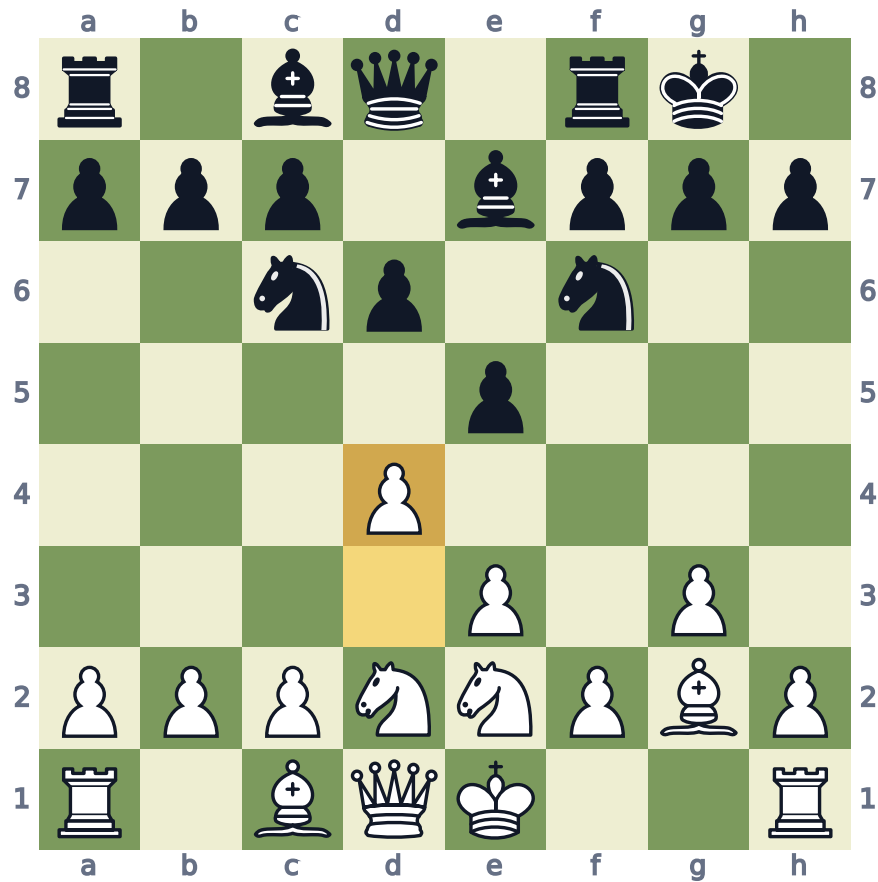
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

Prepare d4 against e5



COURSE LINE

1. g3 e5 2. Bg2 Nf6 3. d3 Nc6 4. Nd2 d6 5. e3 Be7 6. Ne2 O-O 7. d4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

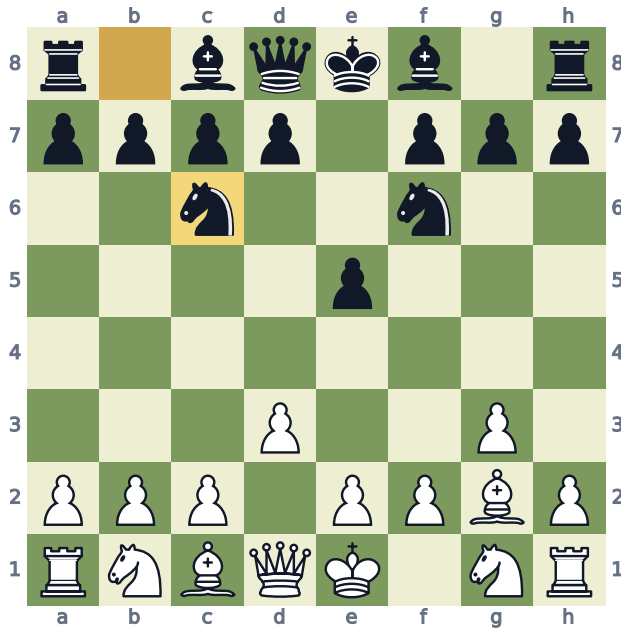
Challenge e5 and open the center when White is fully developed.

MAIN DANGER

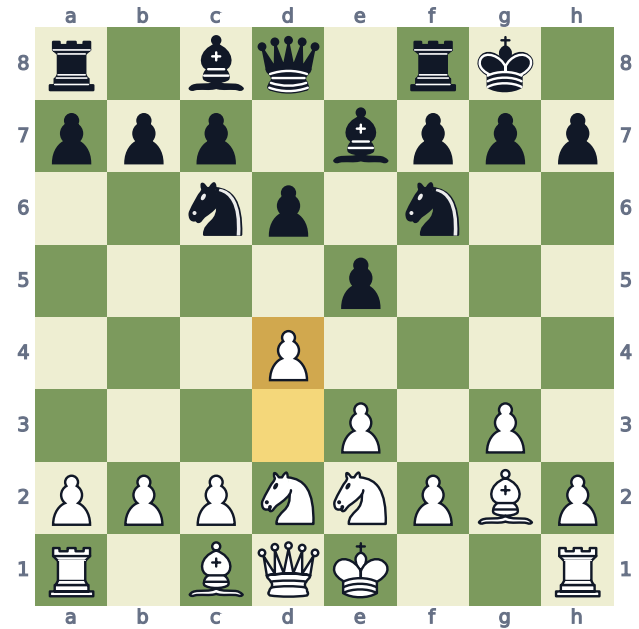
e4 can close the position and begin a kingside plan.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

d4 is ready when castling and piece activity survive the exchanges.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

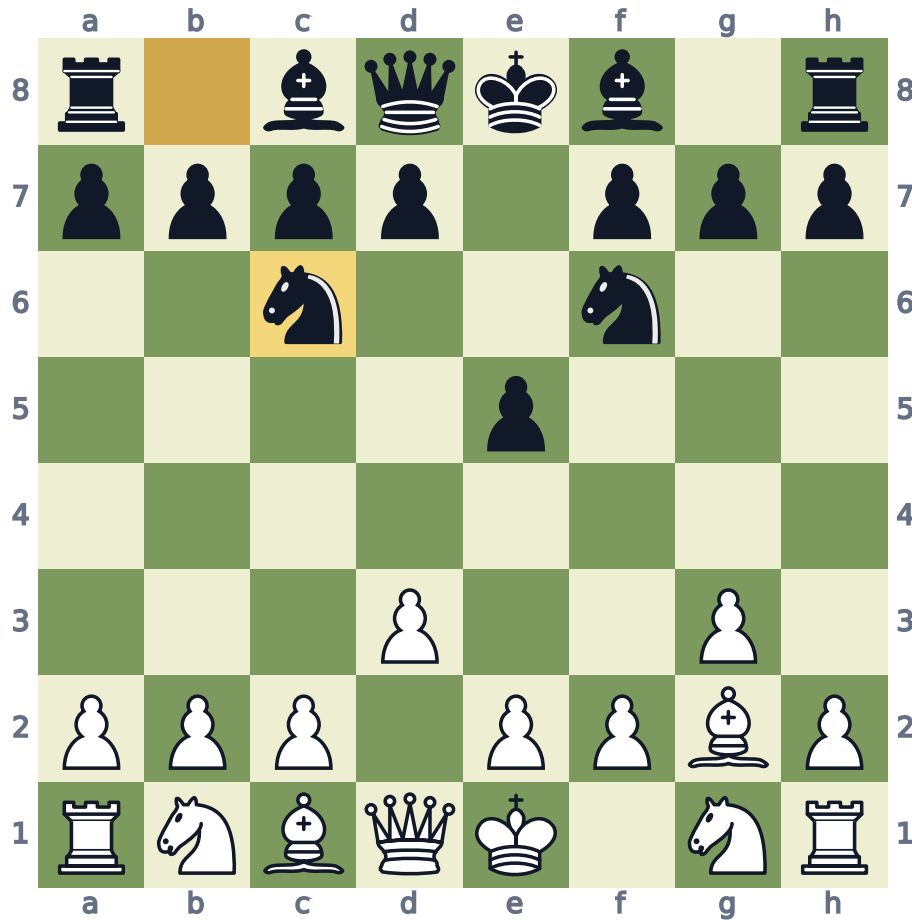
Position estimate: -0.25 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. a5 a3 2. d5 dxe5 3. Nxe5 b3 4. Re8 O-O 5. Bf8 Bb2

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

Prepare d4 against e5



YOUR TASK

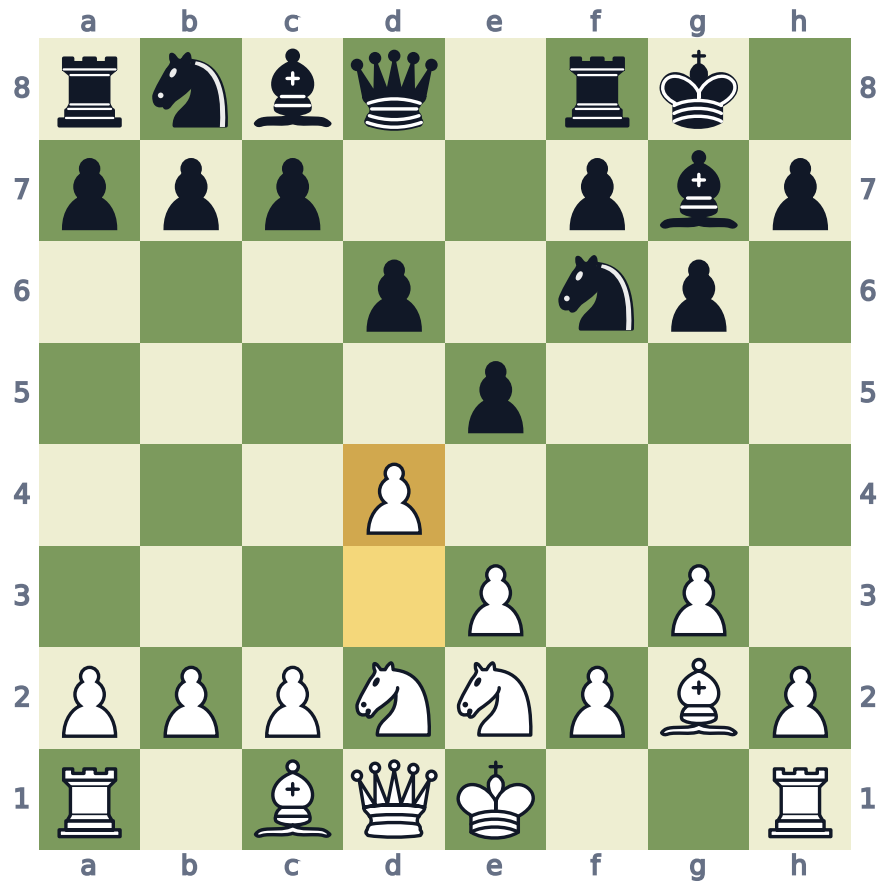
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 06

d4 in a mirrored fianchetto



COURSE LINE

1. g3 Nf6 2. Bg2 g6 3. d3 Bg7 4. Nd2 O-O 5. e3 d6 6. Ne2 e5 7. d4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

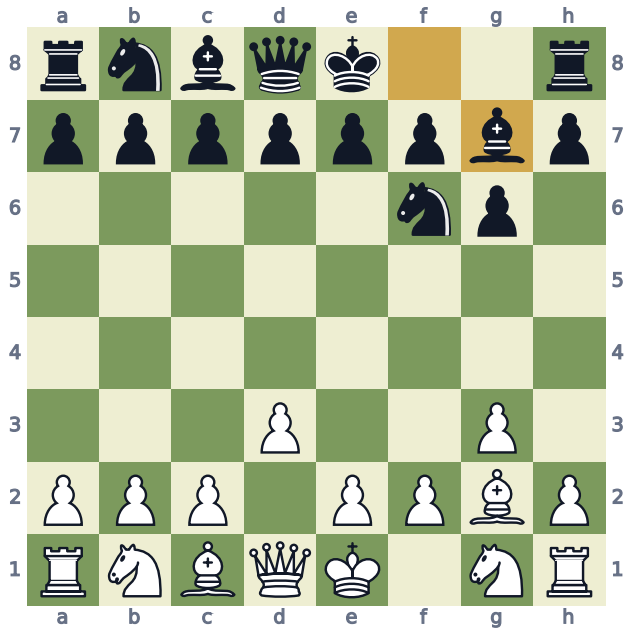
Break symmetry and ask Black to define the central tension.

MAIN DANGER

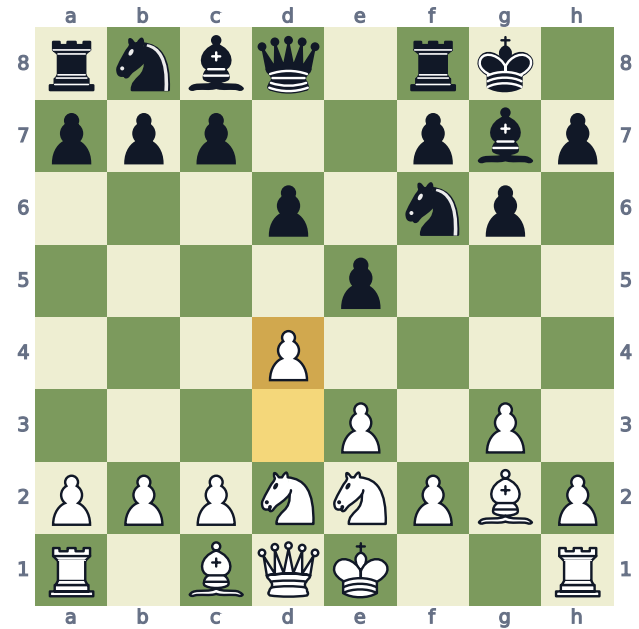
e4 can restrict the g2 bishop.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

The extra tempo is converted into the first useful center break.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

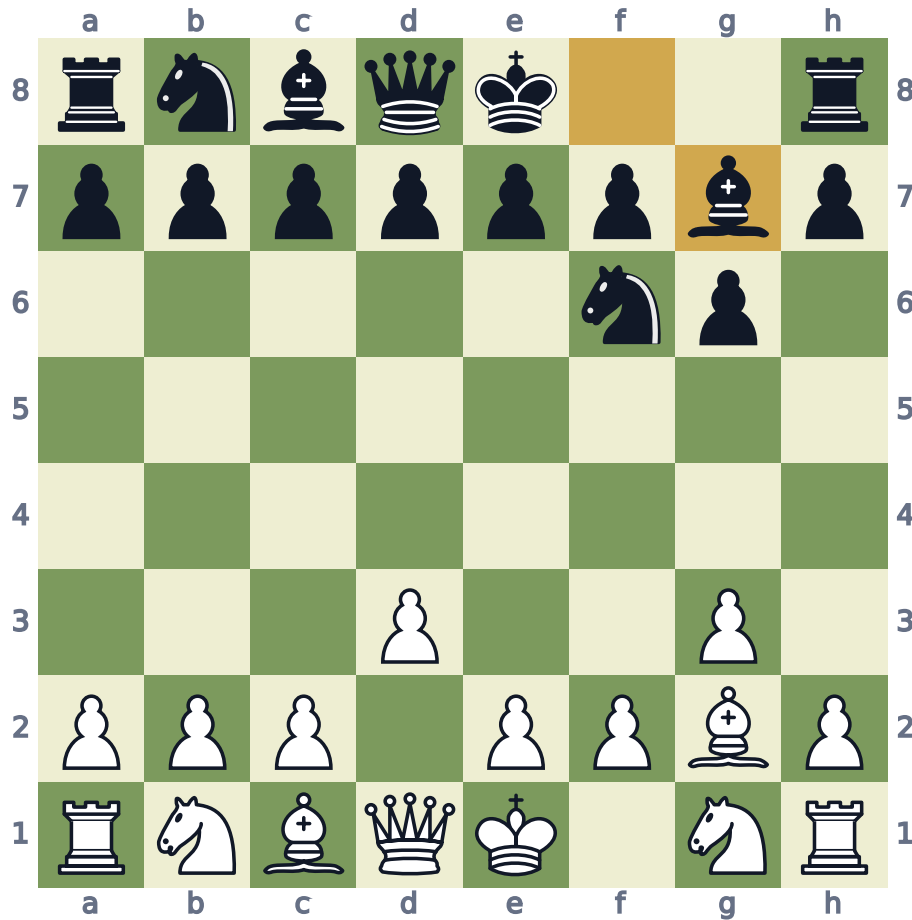
Position estimate: -0.61 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. a5 b3 2. a4 O-O 3. exd4 exd4 4. Re8 Re1 5. axb3 cxb3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

d4 in a mirrored fianchetto



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 07

d4 against a single e5 pawn



COURSE LINE

1. g3 e5 2. Bg2 Nf6 3. d3 d6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 Re8 7. d4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

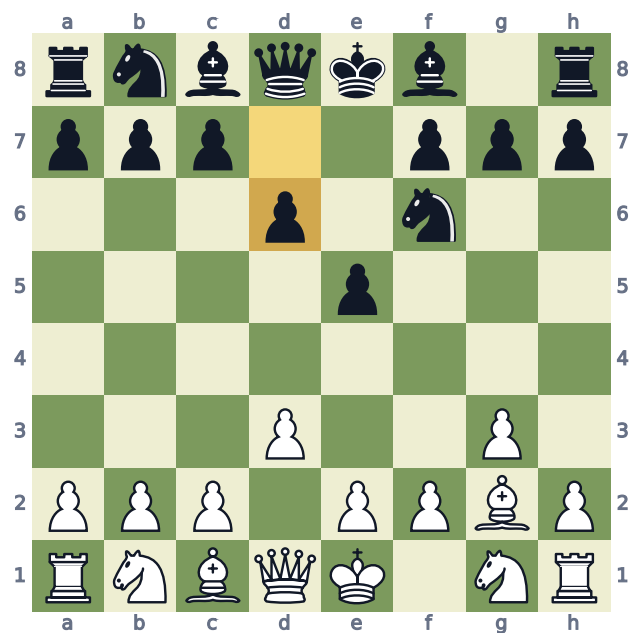
Take central space and free the c1 bishop before Black plays d5.

MAIN DANGER

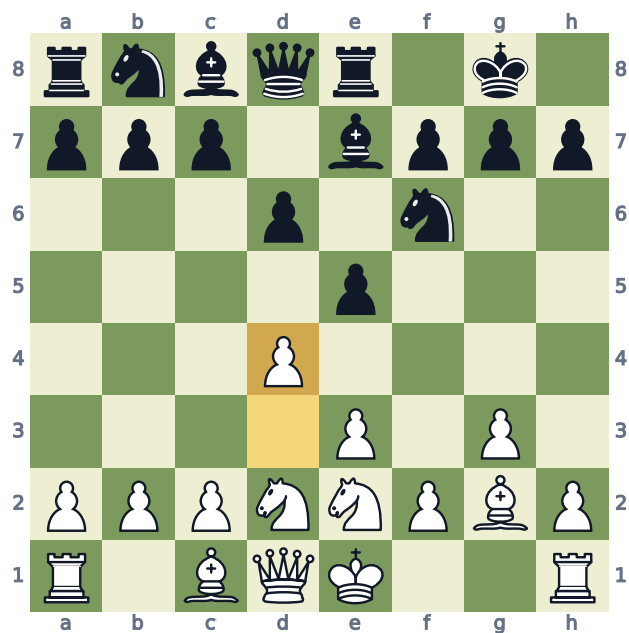
e4 can close the position and attack the kingside.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

When d5 is unavailable, d4 gains more force.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

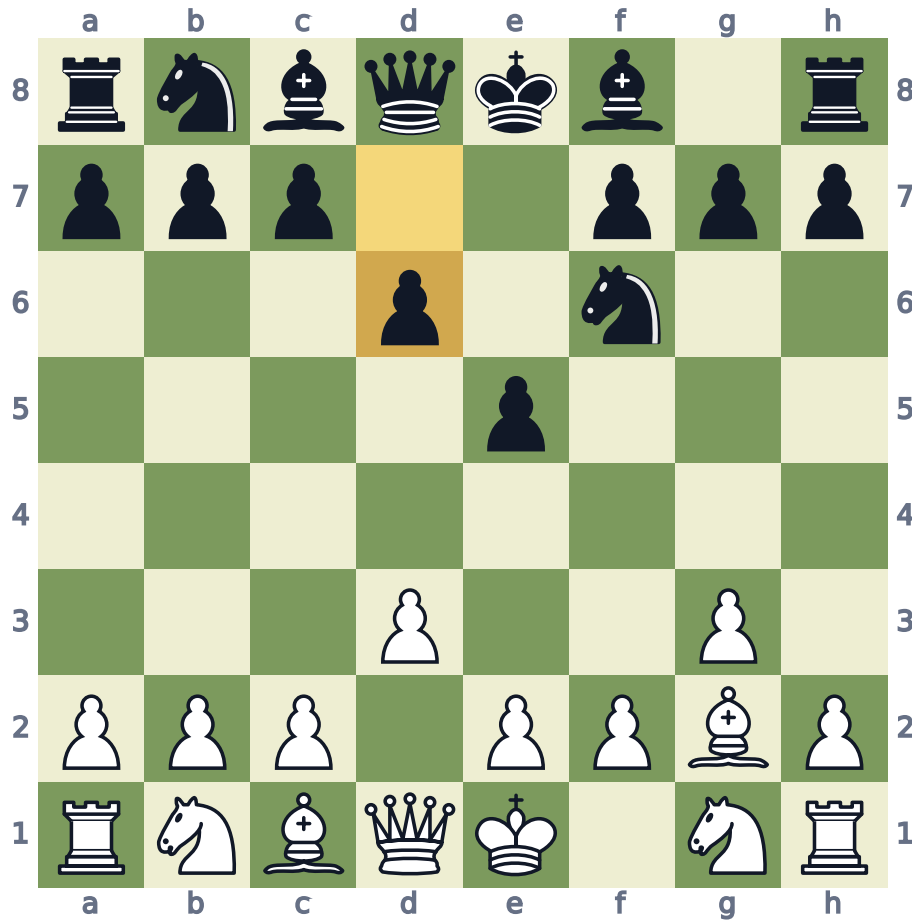
Position estimate: -0.31 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bf8 c4 2. exd4 Nxd4 3. c5 Nb5 4. Nc6 O-O

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

d4 against a single e5 pawn

**YOUR TASK**

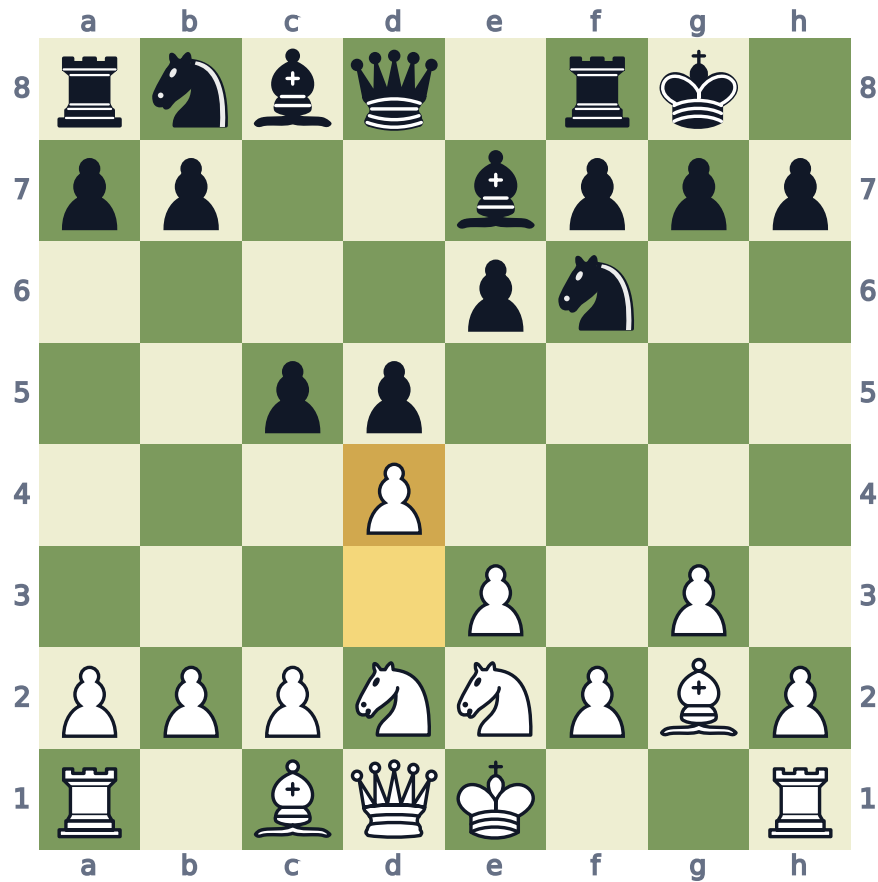
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

Choose between e4 and d4



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 Nf6 3. d3 e6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c5 7. d4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

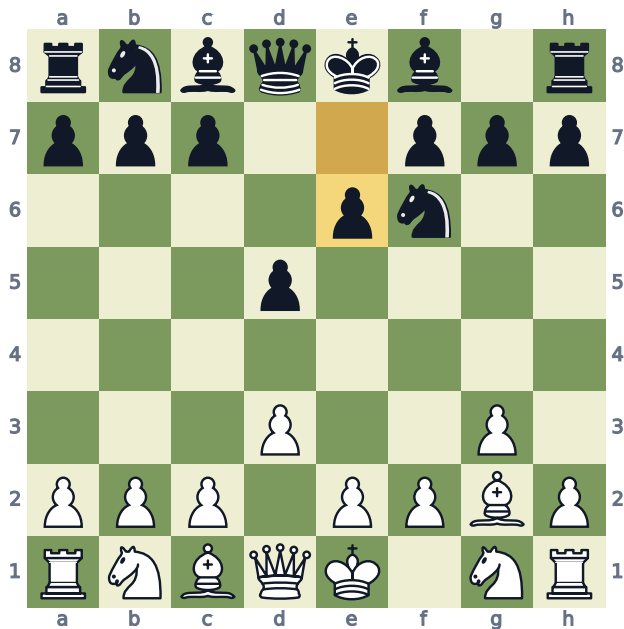
Use d4 when Black's e-pawn does not occupy e5 and central symmetry is acceptable.

MAIN DANGER

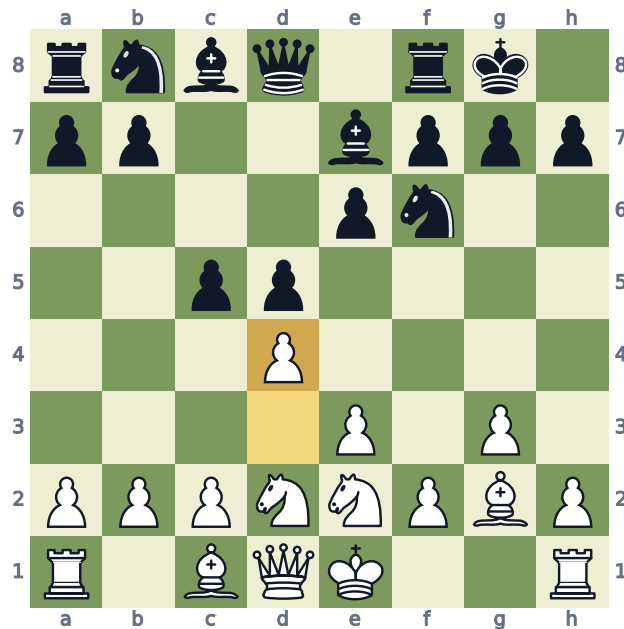
cxd4 can create an isolated pawn or open c-file pressure.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Compare which break opens your better bishop.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

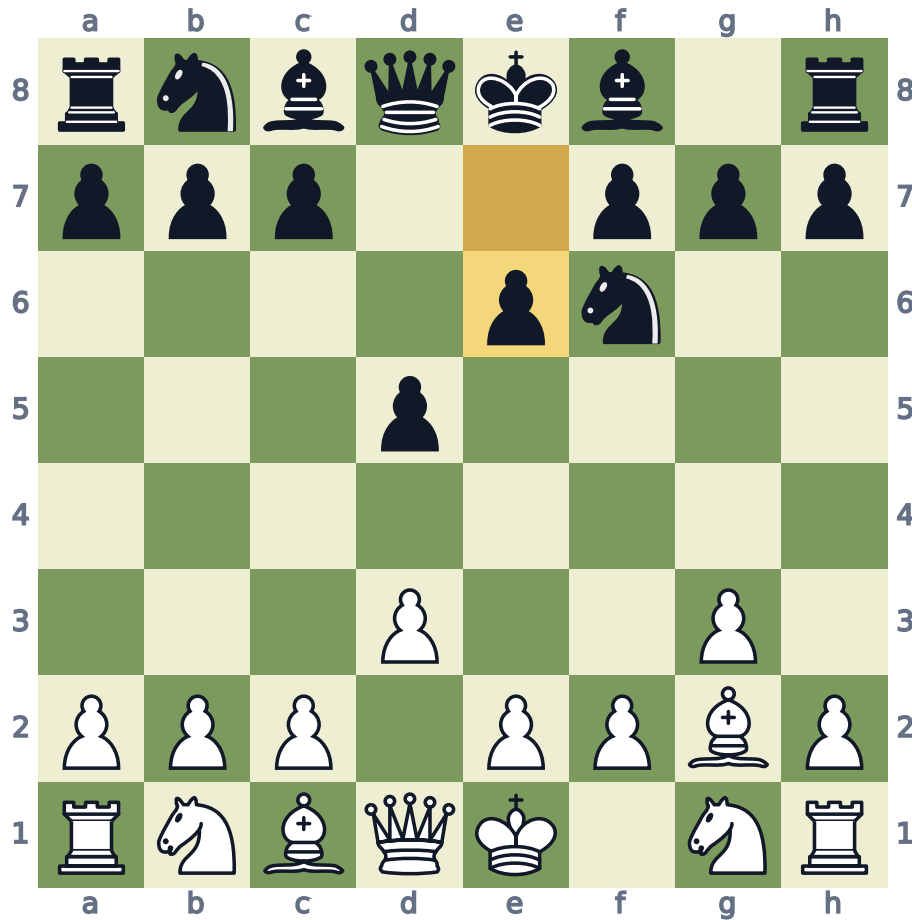
Position estimate: -0.46 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. b5 O-O 2. a5 e4 3. Bb7 e5 4. Nfd7 c3 5. Nc6 Re1

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

Choose between e4 and d4



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. PREPARE E4 WITH D3 AND ND2

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Use d3, Nd2, and Ne2 to support e4 without blocking the f-pawn. Engine comparison: 1. c4 c6 2. Nf3 Bd6 3. O-O h6 4. Nc3 (-0.22 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: d4 can close the center and restrict the knights.

02. E4 AGAINST A FRENCH SHELL

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Challenge d5 and enter a King's Indian Attack structure. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 Be7 2. O-O a5 3. c4 O-O 4. Bf4 h6 5. Re1 (+0.01 for White (equal)). Warning: d4 can gain space and make c4 necessary later.

03. E4 AGAINST A CARO SHELL

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Open central contact after Black's bishop leaves c8. Engine comparison: 1. Nd2 e5 2. Ngf3 Nd7 3. e4 dxe4 4. dxe4 Be6 5. Qe2 Bc5 (+0.45 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: dxe4 can expose an uncastled king.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. E4 IN A SICILIAN STRUCTURE

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Build a Closed Sicilian center while preserving f4. Engine comparison: 1. Nc3 Nf6 2. e4 Bg7 3. Nge2 d6 4. O-O Rb8 5. Nd5 O-O (+0.04 for White (equal)). Warning: d5 can strike the center immediately.

05. PREPARE D4 AGAINST E5

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Challenge e5 and open the center when White is fully developed. Engine comparison: 1. c4 d5 2. cxd5 Nxd5 3. Nc3 Be6 4. Nf3 Be7 5. O-O O-O (+0.01 for White (equal)). Warning: e4 can close the position and begin a kingside plan.

06. D4 IN A MIRRORED FIANCHETTO

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Break symmetry and ask Black to define the central tension. Engine comparison: 1. c4 d5 2. cxd5 Nxd5 (+0.10 for White (equal)). Warning: e4 can restrict the g2 bishop.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-8

07. D4 AGAINST A SINGLE E5 PAWN

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Take central space and free the c1 bishop before Black plays d5. Engine comparison: 1. c4 g6 2. Nc3 Bg7 3. b4 O-O 4. a4 c6 5. Nf3 Re8 (+0.39 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: e4 can close the position and attack the kingside.

08. CHOOSE BETWEEN E4 AND D4

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Use d4 when Black's e-pawn does not occupy e5 and central symmetry is acceptable. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 Be7 2. O-O O-O 3. Nc3 c5 4. e4 Nc6 5. e5 Nd7 (+0.08 for White (equal)). Warning: cxd4 can create an isolated pawn or open c-file pressure.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.